



WSET
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WSET Level 3 mock exam

1. Which best describes an Alsatian Gewurztraminer?
 - a) Dry, medium bodied with high acidity and a flinty mineral character
 - b) Full bodied with oily texture and high alcohol and spicy aromas**
 - c) Dry with a classic grapey flavour

2. The appellations of Blaye, Cadillac, Castillon, and Francs can put their names in front of:
 - a) Côtes de Gascogne
 - b) Côtes de Bordeaux**
 - c) Premières Côtes de Bordeaux

3. Which appellation accounts for more than half of production in the Southern Rhône?
 - a) Côtes du Rhône**
 - b) Côtes du Rhône Villages
 - c) Châteauneuf-du-Pape

4. Which of the following alcohol levels would be considered medium for a light wine?
 - a) 10.5%
 - b) 12.5%**
 - c) 14.5%

5. Which of the following best describes a wine that is medium-dry?
 - a) The wine has a tiny bit of detectable sugar
 - b) There is a distinct presence of sugar but not sweet enough to pair with dessert**
 - c) Sugar has become the prominent feature of the wine

6. Aromas that have their origin in the post-fermentation process are:
 - a) Primary aromas
 - b) Secondary aromas**
 - c) Tertiary aromas

7. How many sub-regions are the vineyards of the Douro Valley divided into?
 - a) 3**
 - b) 4
 - c) 5

8. Languedoc AC red wines follow a similar blend as is found in:
- a) Bordeaux
 - b) Chinon
 - c) Southern Rhône**
9. If a wine shows primary aromas with light acid or tannin, it would like be classified as:
- a) Too young
 - b) Drink now, but has potential for ageing
 - c) Drink now: not suitable for further ageing**
10. How many grapes can be used to make Châteauneuf-du-Pape?
- a) 4
 - b) 13**
 - c) 27
11. Which term refers to a German wine that is off-dry to medium?
- a) Goldtröpfchen
 - b) Halbtrocken**
 - c) Prädikatswein
12. Which is the most widely planted red grape in Austria?
- a) Blaufränkisch
 - b) St. Laurent
 - c) Zweigelt**
13. Acidic wines pair well with foods that are:
- a) High in umami
 - b) Very bitter
 - c) Rich in fat or oil**
14. What is *Strohwein*?
- a) Wine fermented with straw to add a hay-like flavour
 - b) Grapes are laid out on straw to dry and concentrate sugars**
 - c) Noble-rot affected sweet wines from Wachau
15. Sweet wines from Santorini are known as:
- a) Ausbruch
 - b) Puttony
 - c) Vinsanto**
16. How many buds are retained with spur pruning?
- a) 2 – 3**
 - b) 4 – 7
 - c) 8 - 20

17. What is a clone?
- a) **Cross of 2 *Vitis vinifera* grapes**
 - b) Genetic mutation of a parent grape
 - c) Cross of a *Vitis vinifera* grape and another *Vitis* species of grape
18. Which part of the vine is a *cordon*?
- a) New shoots
 - b) **Arm of permanent wood**
 - c) The buds
19. How is a Recioto wine produced?
- a) Fermentation is stopped with fortification
 - b) Wine is fermented dry and sweetened later
 - c) **Fermentation stops naturally due to high sugar levels in the grapes**
20. In which region is the Teroldego grape grown?
- a) Veneto
 - b) Friuli-Venezia Giulia
 - c) **Trentino**
21. What is the definition of a continental climate?
- a) Cool to moderate temperatures with low annual difference
 - b) **Greatest difference between the hottest and coldest months**
 - c) Low temperature difference between seasons with warm, dry summers
22. Which of the following Chablis categories is most likely to show some use of oak?
- a) Petit Chablis
 - b) Chablis
 - c) **Chablis Grand Cru**
23. How long must a Barolo DOCG wine be aged for?
- a) 1 year
 - b) 2 years
 - c) **3 years**
24. How long must a Chianti Classico be aged before release?
- a) 6 months
 - b) **12 months**
 - c) 18 months
25. What is the main grape in a Valpolicella wine?
- a) **Corvina**
 - b) Dolcetto
 - c) Nero d'Avola

26. What is the main grape in a Salice Salentino DOC wine?
- a) Nero d' Avola
 - b) Negroamaro**
 - c) Primitivo
27. Which of the following does not help combat frost?
- a) Drip irrigation**
 - b) Sprinklers
 - c) Wind machines
28. A Warm Climate has a temperature range of:
- a) 16.5°C - 18.5°C
 - b) 18.5°C - 21°C**
 - c) Greater than 21°C
29. How many white varieties are approved for use in a white Rioja?
- a) 4
 - b) 6
 - c) 8**
30. Water hazards in a vineyard do not include:
- a) Drought
 - b) Excessive water
 - c) Cloud cover**
31. Which AVA in California is a source for aromatic white grapes?
- a) Mount Veeder
 - b) Anderson Valley**
 - c) Lodi
32. Which of the following is a type of must enrichment to increase the potential alcohol of a light wine?
- a) Chaptalization**
 - b) Süssreserve
 - c) Adding grape spirit
33. At what temperature does fermentation stop?
- a) 12°C
 - b) 22°C
 - c) 35°C**
34. Which of the following wine styles would be deliberately oxidized in partially-filled oak?
- a) New Zealand Sauvignon Blanc
 - b) Burgundian Pinot Noir
 - c) Oloroso Sherry**

35. What is Argentina's most southerly wine region?

- a) **Patagonia**
- b) Salta
- c) San Juan

36. What is meant by racking?

- a) **Wine is pumped into a different vessel leaving the sediment behind**
- b) Wine ageing in oak barrels are stored on warehouse racks
- c) Wine is left on its lees and stirred regularly

37. Which region on the North Island of New Zealand has the longest sunshine hours?

- a) Auckland
- b) Martinborough
- c) **Hawke's Bay**

38. Which of these is not a form of clarification?

- a) Sedimentation
- b) Fining
- c) **SO₂ Addition**

39. What is the name of the south-easterly summer winds in South Africa?

- a) Doctor Wine
- b) Benguela
- c) **Cape Doctor**

40. Which of the districts below is known for quality wine production in South Africa?

- a) **Stellenbosch**
- b) Worcester
- c) Robertson

41. What is the main grape used in Sherry production?

- a) **Palomino**
- b) Pedro Ximénez
- c) Muscat of Alexandria

42. White winemaking for aromatic wines like Riesling and Sauvignon Blanc will typically see:

- a) Aging in new oak barrels to allow the wines to breath and add flavour
- b) Malolactic fermentation to soften the high acidity
- c) **Inert vessel fermentation to preserve primary fruit character**

43. Which of the following is not a way to create sweet wines?

- a) **Chaptalisation**
- b) Addition of *Süssreserve*
- c) Drying grapes post-harvest

44. Which method produces the most delicately coloured rosé?

- a) **Direct pressing**
- b) Short maceration
- c) Blending

45. Which is not a cap management technique?

- a) **Carbonic maceration**
- b) Punching Down
- c) Rotary fermentation

46. Which grape does not belong in Alsace?

- a) Sylvaner
- b) **Viognier**
- c) Pinot Blanc

47. Which is the only red grape permitted in Alsace?

- a) Gamay
- b) Merlot
- c) **Pinot Noir**

48. Which Muscat variety makes the best Muscat wines in Alsace?

- a) Muscat of Alexandria
- b) **Muscat Blanc à Petits Grains**
- c) Muscat Ottonel

49. Which term is related to a late harvest wine in Alsace?

- a) Sélection de Grains Nobles
- b) Spätlese
- c) **Vendage Tardive**

50. What country produces Rutherglen Muscat?

- a) South Africa
- b) France
- c) **Australia**

Question 1 (25 marks)



a. What does the term Aszu indicate about this wine? (2 marks)

The term "Aszú" refers to sweet wines made from grapes affected by noble rot.

b. Describe the growing conditions and harvesting of grapes for this style of wine (6 marks)

Growing conditions:

- Tokaji benefits from a continental climate with warm, sunny autumns that encourage noble rot development.
- The Bodrog and Tisza rivers create morning mists, essential for the development of Botrytis cinerea, followed by dry afternoons to prevent undesirable rot.

Harvesting:

- Grapes are harvested by hand, often in multiple passes (tries) to select only the Aszú berries affected by noble rot.
- The harvesting period is long and labor-intensive to ensure optimal ripeness and concentration.

c. Describe the style of this wine (5 marks)

Luscious

High Acidity High, balancing the sweetness and contributing to the wine's longevity.

Full Body Full-bodied with a rich, luscious texture.

Flavors of dried apricots, honey, orange marmalade, nuts, and caramel.

d. The production of Tokaji Aszu starts with a base wine that is made from healthy grapes. Describe the winemaking process from this point. (5 marks)

1. Aszú berries are macerated in the finished base wine.
2. The mixture is pressed to separate the liquid from the solids.
3. Fermentation occurs slowly due to the high sugar concentration.
4. The wine is aged in oak barrels
5. The aging process can last for several years, contributing to the wine's complex style.

e. What is the term for a wine made using just the free run juice from Osuzu berries (2 marks)

Eszencia

f. What conditions would you recommend for the long-term storage of this wine (4 marks)

Temperature: Store at a consistent cool temperature, ideally 10–15°C.

Humidity: Maintain high humidity (around 75–80%) to protect cork integrity.

Light: Keep in complete darkness to avoid damage from UV light.

Position: Store bottles on their side to keep the cork moist and airtight

Question 2 (25 marks)

Germany

a. In the table below, state the SIX categories of German Pradikatswein, linking them to their corresponding wine style / level of sweetness (6 marks)

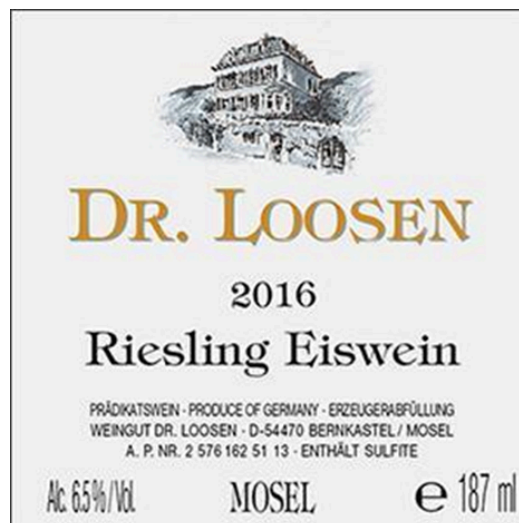
<u>Category/ies of pradikat</u>	<u>Wine style / level of sweetness</u>
Kabinett Spatlese	dry to medium sweet
Auslese	dry to sweet
Bereen Auslese Trockenbeerenauslese Eiswein	sweet only

The following 3 questions relate to the wines pictured below

Wine 1



Wine 2



b. Describe the style of wine 1 (6 marks)

Dry to medium sweet

High acidity

Low abv

Light Body

Floral - blossom, chamomile

Green fruit - green apple, rapes, pear

Citrus fruit - lime, lemon

c. Describe the process involved in the production of wine 2 (4 marks)

Healthy grapes are left to freeze on the vine Once frozen grapes are picked and gently pressed sugar content is increased as ice remains in press fermentation starts and stops naturally before all sugar is converted into alcohol MLF and oak are avoided

d. How do these processes affect the style of wine 2? (3 marks)

Frozen grapes —> concentrate sugar level and flavours

healthy grapes —> keep varietal character

Fermentation stops —> 6-7abv

No MLF or oak —> pure varietal character

Question 3 (25 marks)

Part 1. Pinot Noir

a. Pinot Noir is best grown in cool and moderate climates. Why is this?

Pinot Noir is early ripening (1 mark)

In hot climates it can become jammy and unattractive (1 mark)

b. The two regions stated below can grow Pinot Noir successfully. For each region, identify TWO

natural factors and explain how they moderate the climate.

Los Carneros

Natural Factors:

Fogs

Breezes

Explanation:

Fog will keep vineyards cooler in the morning (1 mark) by blocking the sun (1 mark) Fog will blanket the vineyards (1 mark) so they are slower to warm up (1 mark)

Breezes will cool vineyards in the afternoon (1 mark) to moderate the hot afternoon temperatures in vineyard (1 mark)

Central Otago

Natural Factors:

Diurnal range (1 mark)

Altitude (1 mark)

Southern latitude (1 mark)

Explanation:

A large diurnal range provides cool temperatures at night (1 mark) and slows down the warming of the vineyard in the day (1 mark)

Higher altitude vineyards are cooler (1 mark) and will have lower day and night time temperatures (1 mark)

The most southerly wine-making region in NZ, it is furthest away from the equator (1 mark) giving longer days during the growing season (1 mark)

Part 2. Semillon is a grape that is used in the Hunter Valley to produce distinctive wines.

a. Identify ONE human influence in the vineyard and ONE human influence in the winery which contribute to the distinctive characteristics of Hunter Valley Semillon. Explain how they do so.

Vineyard influence:

Grapes picked early (1 mark))

Retains high levels of natural acidity making the wine refreshing (up to 2 marks)

Retains high levels of natural acidity to aid long ageing in bottle (up to 2 marks)

Neutral green fruit and citrus character from early-picked grapes (up to 2 marks)

Winery influence:

Inert vessel used for fermentation/post-fermentation storage

Contact with oxygen kept to a minimum

Extended ageing in bottle

Inert vessels retain neutral fruit character

Protection from oxygen prevents oxidised characteristics developing

Bottle ageing contributes to flavours of honey and toast often found in these wines

Part 3. Chardonnay is widely grown throughout California.

a. Explain why the producer of an outstanding quality Chardonnay from Russian River Valley AVA might choose to use malolactic fermentation.

It can enhance the quality of a wine, by

softening and reducing acidity

the creation of buttery flavours

giving a round, creamy mouthfeel

improving microbiological stability.

It also suits the relatively neutral fruit profile of Chardonnay

Question 4 (25 marks)

Part 1. Sparkling Wines

a. Explain why a producer of traditional method sparkling wines requires grapes with relatively low sugar levels.

**The producers aim to produce a base dry wine of 10-11% abv (1 mark)
to allow for an increase in alcohol during 2nd fermentation of 1.2-1.3% abv (1 mark)
High levels of acid associated with low sugar levels are required for a
refreshing style of sparkling wine (1 mark)**

b. Name and describe the process by which traditional method sparkling wines acquire flavours of bread and biscuit.

**Yeast autolysis
Once second fermentation is complete the yeast die and form a sediment of lees
in the bottle
Dead yeast cells break down and release chemical compounds into the wine
The longer wine spends in contact with the dead yeast cells, the more intense the
flavours**

c. Identify and describe two ways of making sparkling wines sweet.

**Method 1:
Use of liqueur d'expédition
Adding a wine sugar solution to a dry sparkling wine
Amount of sugar in the solution will determine the level of sweetness
Method 2:
Tank method or Asti method
Fermentation is stopped early before all the sugars are fermented
Fermentation stopped by chilling the wine
Wine is filtered to remove the yeast and bottled immediately**

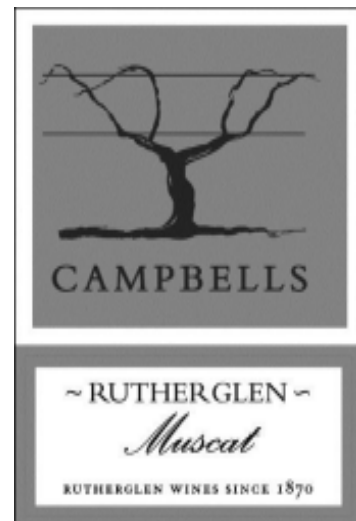


Part 2. Fortified Wines.

Wine A



Wine B



- a. The two wines pictured on the previous page are both fortified wines made from the Muscat grapes.. Describe how they are made.

Wine A

Made from ripe unraised grapes (1 mark)
Grapes crushed (1 mark)
Skin contact to enhance flavours (1 mark)
Cool fermentation in inert vessel (1 mark)
Fermentation stopped by fortification with spirit of 96% abv (1 mark)
Stored in inert vessels prior to bottling (1 mark)

Wine B

Grapes allowed to raisin on vine (1 mark)
Fermentation on skins (1 mark)
Fortification takes place when fermentation has reached 2% (1 mark)
Oxidative ageing (1 mark)
Old and large format oak used (1 mark)
Aged in warm conditions (1 mark)
Blended before bottling (1 mark)

- b. Vintage Port is aged in bottle and will need decanting before serving. Describe the process of opening and decanting a fully mature Vintage Port.

Remove horizontally from its rack (1 mark)
Place in decanting basket or hold to make sure deposit is not agitated (1 mark)
Remove top of capsule (1 mark)
Clean the shoulder and neck of bottle (1 mark)
Gently remove cork (1 mark)
Hold bottle in front of light pour wine into decanter (1 mark)
Stop pouring when deposit is seen in near the neck (1 mark)

